

AUDIT INVESTIGATION REPORT

Investigation No. INV-00457 | Type: Fraud Investigation

Investigation ID:	INV-00457
Investigation Type:	Fraud Investigation
Status:	COMPLETED
Trigger Source:	Automated anomaly detection alert
Lead Investigator:	Douglas Lara (EMP-14347)
Subject Employee:	Maria Washington (EMP-32095)
Related Vendor:	CoreVault Systems Ltd (VND-00695)
Related Transaction:	TXN-857561
Scope Period:	2021-05-13 to 2021-08-31
Created Date:	2025-09-15
Completed Date:	2026-01-18
Outcome:	SUBSTANTIATED

1. AUDIT QUESTION

"Which high-risk or critical-risk vendors have received payments in the past 12 months?"

2. BACKGROUND

This investigation was initiated following a automated anomaly detection alert relating to activity associated with employee Maria Washington (EMP-32095) and vendor CoreVault Systems Ltd (VND-00695). The investigation scope covers the period 2021-05-13 to 2021-08-31 and was conducted under the authority of the Internal Audit Charter and the Fraud Risk Management Policy.

3. METHODOLOGY

The investigation team reviewed transaction records, approval workflow logs, and supporting documentation associated with Transaction ID TXN-857561 (amount 444,535.34 EUR, risk score 0.90). Interviews were conducted with relevant personnel and system access logs were reviewed for the scope period.

4. FINDINGS

Finding ID	Severity	Category	Description
FND-002428	LOW	POLICY BREACH	Employee submitted Meals claim 13% above the authorised policy limit without prior exception approval.
FND-003327	LOW	POLICY BREACH	Claim EXP-195162 violates Policy POL-0011 section 4.2: Marketing expenditure capped at \$100,000 per event.

5. CONCLUSION

Based on the evidence reviewed, the allegations underlying this investigation are **SUBSTANTIATED**. The control breakdown identified poses a low risk to the organisation and requires remediation.

6. ACTIONS TAKEN

- Vendor placed under enhanced monitoring with quarterly compliance re-checks.

7. SIGN-OFF

Role	Name	Employee ID	Date
Lead Investigator	Douglas Lara	EMP-14347	2026-01-18